

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1103

By Pearson

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize the thirty-ninth annual Africa in April Cultural Awareness Festival in Memphis and to commend Yvonne and David Acey for their leadership and service to the Memphis community.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize events that celebrate cultural heritage, promote education, and strengthen the bonds of community throughout the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the Africa in April Cultural Awareness Festival, held annually in Memphis, is a treasured cultural tradition that highlights the rich heritage, history, and artistic expressions of the African continent and the African Diaspora; and

WHEREAS, in 2026, this remarkable festival celebrates its thirty-ninth anniversary, marking nearly four decades of cultural celebration, education, and economic opportunity for artists, performers, educators, and vendors from across the Mid-South and beyond; and

WHEREAS, the festival provides a vibrant platform for cultural exchange, offering lectures, exhibitions, musical performances, culinary experiences, and family-centered programming that uplift the traditions and global influence of African cultures; and

WHEREAS, Africa in April has grown into one of the largest cultural festivals in the region, drawing thousands of residents and visitors to the City of Memphis each year and contributing to the cultural vitality and economic development of the community; and

WHEREAS, the continued success of the Africa in April Cultural Awareness Festival is made possible through the dedication and leadership of community advocates who believe in the power of culture to inspire unity and understanding; and

WHEREAS, Yvonne Acey and David Acey, widely respected leaders in Memphis and affectionately known as a Memphis power couple, have demonstrated exceptional commitment

to uplifting the community and supporting initiatives that celebrate African heritage and culture;  
and

WHEREAS, through their leadership, advocacy, and service, Yvonne and David Acey have helped ensure that the Africa in April Festival continues to flourish as a beacon of cultural pride, education, and community engagement; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly recognize the significance of the Africa in April Cultural Awareness Festival and commend those who work diligently to preserve and promote its mission; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby recognize and celebrate the thirty-ninth annual Africa in April Cultural Awareness Festival in Memphis and commend Yvonne Acey and David Acey for their outstanding leadership, dedication, and service to the Memphis community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.